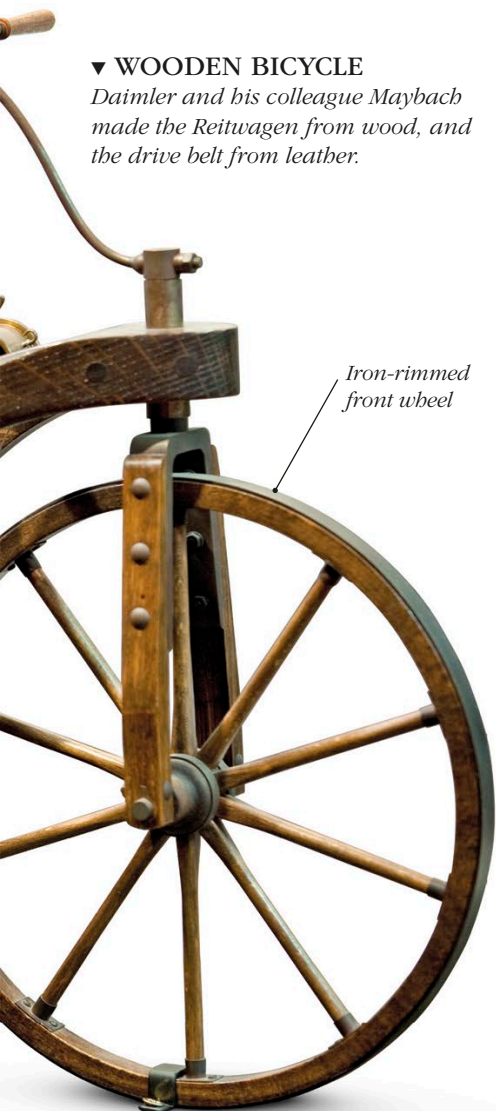


▼ WOODEN BICYCLE

Daimler and his colleague Maybach made the Reitwagen from wood, and the drive belt from leather.



Iron-rimmed front wheel



First electric superbike

- **What?** Lightning LS-218
- **Who?** Lightning
- **Where and when?** US, 2010

Most people thought electric motorcycles were slow and dull. Nobody imagined a bike that could whiz along almost silently, driven by only an electric motor. The Lightning LS-218 changed people's minds by becoming the fastest bike on the road at the time, with a top speed of 218mph (350.8km/h).

Vespa 125, 1951



Vespa scooter

- **What?** Vespa
- **Who?** Piaggio
- **Where and when?** Italy, 1946

The Italian Piaggio company decided to build a comfortable, stylish, easy-to-ride two-wheeler for zipping through the country's narrow and bumpy streets. The result was the Vespa (wasp) scooter, which continues to be a huge success.



First superbike

- **What?** Honda CB750 Dream
- **Who?** Honda
- **Where and when?** Japan, 1969

The Honda 750 Dream was the first "superbike"—a comfortable and extremely powerful modern bike. Up until then, bikes had to be started with a kick-start ignition. The CB750 was a high-performance bike with a simple push button electric start and disk brakes for stopping quickly.



Water-cooled superbike

- **What?** BMW R1200GS
- **Who?** BMW Motorrad
- **Where and when?** Germany, 2012

Typically, bike engines are cooled by flowing air, but that works well only when the bike is moving fast. So, some bikes have a jacket of cooling water circulating around the engine to make the engine quieter and more reliable. The BMW R1200GS is a powerful superbike that is cooled using both air and water.

Futuristic motorbike

- **What?** BMW Vision Next 100
- **Who?** BMW Motorrad
- **Where and when?** Germany, 2016

Some bike manufacturers are developing bikes with an amazing gyroscopic system that keeps them upright under all circumstances, no matter what the rider does. The BMW Vision Next 100 is one such test bike. When riding, the

biker wears a special visor with a data display that is activated when required. This bike might be a one-off or a sign of motorcycles to come in the future.

